

Une Faible Impression (*A Faint Impression*)

Color-coded script · Rev. 1.3 · Chowdhury & Zaman

Each scene has its own color; beats within a scene (1A, 1B, 1C...) alternate between two tints of that color so boundaries are easy to spot at a glance. Same 8-scene / 23-beat breakdown as the shot-list worksheet — read them side by side.

Outline — 1 Park Bench (5 beats) · 2 Woods/Boy (1) · 3 Park Road (2) · 4 Woods (1) · 5 Bollard Area (7) · 6 Woods (1) · 7 Lover's Leap (5) · 8 Woods (1)

SCENE 1 — EXT. PARK BENCH — SUNRISE

1A · LETTER, THREE TRIES

MAN sits contemplatively on a bench, sun rising behind him, ignored. Picks up NOTEBOOK and PEN.

MAN (V.O.)

Chère Maman... Je pense à toi. (Dear Mom... I miss you.)

Unsatisfied, scratches it out. Exhales, starts again.

MAN (V.O.)

Chère Maman... Je réfléchissais à l'idée de marche en avant... (...thinking about progress... reminded me of our train ride from Toulouse to... I can't remember where...)

Still unsatisfied, scratches out again. Final breath.

MAN (V.O.)

Maman... Que voulais-tu dire quand tu as dit: «Il faut entendre le mot avec la résonance du monde.»

...parce que le mot— (...What did you mean: "hear the word with the sound of the world"... because the word—)

1B · THE LOST WORD / WOMAN APPEARS

MAN forgets the French word for "beckon."

WOMAN (O.S.)

Appelle... [repeats 3x: MAN doesn't notice, then searches for the source, then goes back to his notebook]

MAN remembers: Appelle. Begins writing. A WOMAN, early 30s, is seated on a parallel bench.

MAN (V.O.)

Le mot m'appelle loin du confort... (The word beckons me away from comfort...)

1C · "COME HERE OFTEN?"

WOMAN

Come here often?

MAN *(surprised)*

Huh?

WOMAN *(louder)*

Do you come here often?

MAN

Ah... yes. In the mornings, you?

WOMAN *(smiles)*

Wouldn't you know, if you come here often?

MAN *(smiles back)*

Not with certainty.

WOMAN

Just passing through. Duluth. Keokuck. Now... as good a stop as any, wouldn't you say?

MAN

Why?

WOMAN gestures toward the landscape with her eyes.

MAN

Why are you passing through?

WOMAN prepares a big anecdote.

MAN *(cuts her off)*

What are you reading?

1D · BOOK & MAP

WOMAN

Oh, Pushkin.

Holds up the BOOK — a worn Eugene Onegin.

MAN

In Russian?

WOMAN

No, translation.

MAN (*disinterested*)

Oh.

MAN returns to NOTEBOOK. WOMAN pulls out a folded MAP.

WOMAN

Would you happen to know the way out?

MAN

Straight down. Take a right at the sycamore by the bend. Then you'll hit the main road.

WOMAN

What does a sycamore look like?

MAN

If you have gone too far, you'll know.

1E · CIGARETTE / WIND / PAPER FLIES

MAN closes NOTEBOOK, stands, lights a CIGARETTE. WOMAN folds the map, returns to her book.

WOMAN (*while reading*)

If it's not translatable, why do we bother?

MAN (*defeated*)

Hmm... Feeble meaning is better than nothing at all.

A gust of wind through the trees. Both surprised.

WOMAN

Is it a poem?

MAN

Something like that. [Laughs] It doesn't rhyme.

WOMAN stands, looks into the distance. Stronger gust — MAN's SHEET OF PAPER flies away, twisting in the air. MAN chases it.

WOMAN

Hah... He has a very rebellious turn of mind...

WOMAN slowly follows. MAN picks up the fallen PAPER.

SCENE 2 — EXT. WOODS/FOREST — DAYTIME

2A · BOY, ALONE

A young BOY, 7, picks up some soil. He thinks he hears his name and turns toward it. What is its source?

Slowly, he walks. Is he being pulled, or is he searching?

SCENE 3 — EXT. PARK ROAD — MOMENTS LATER

3A · TRAIN STORY / "I MISSPOKE"

MAN and WOMAN walk the road. MAN puts his LIGHTER in his pocket.

WOMAN *(comfortable, smoking)*

On my way up from Ste. Genevieve, train got delayed... because of another train... Man behind me gets a call from his wife... She's angry because surely he is cheating again... Hah...

MAN

You said you came from Keokuck...

WOMAN

I misspoke...

They walk in silence.

WOMAN *(cont.)*

The train stops half a mile too far. He passes her house on the train... to get to her house...

MAN

Feels like fate, no?

WOMAN

I am indifferent to fate.

3B · HALF-MILE HOME / SMALL BEAUTY

MAN

A half-mile walk isn't too far, if it takes you home.

WOMAN

Every time I go home, this tiredness overcomes me...

MAN and WOMAN look up. They notice a small beauty. Is it a tree? A bird?

SCENE 4 — EXT. WOODS — MOMENTS LATER

4A · BOY IN THE WOODS / VO OVER IMAGE

BOY navigates through the woods, cuts through bushes and trees, arrives at an opening.

WOMAN (V.O.)

It's so beautiful that you think you discovered it...

MAN (V.O.)

And if we didn't?

WOMAN (V.O.)

But... it feels like the beginning of a process, rather than an end in itself...

MAN (V.O.)

Oh, beauty... [Pause] The blindness to which it gave rise... If only we could see.

WOMAN (V.O.)

What would we see?

MAN (V.O.)

We would see straight away that something is true, and something is false.

SCENE 5 — EXT. BOLLARD AREA/PARK — MOMENTS LATER

5A · CIGARETTE / STAY ANOTHER DAY

MAN and WOMAN weave through a set of bollards.

MAN

Cigarette?

WOMAN

No...

Man lights one more CIGARETTE for himself.

MAN

When do you leave?

WOMAN

Soon.

MAN

Stay another day. See the city.

WOMAN

No...

MAN

What's the hurry?

MAN and WOMAN sit on bollards.

5B · BREATH / TWO SUNRISES / L'AVENIR

WOMAN

Time... Maybe on a cooler, quieter day, I would have said yes...

MAN blows into the air — you can see his breath. Is it not cool enough? WOMAN smiles.

MAN

It takes two sunrises to know this town...

WOMAN

L'avenir nous prend les bras... Or something. *(The future seizes us by the arms — misspoken; she meant "L'avenir nous tend les bras/The future awaits us...")*

MAN is shaken by the phrase. He stops, trying to understand.

5C · WEDDING / GUATEMALA

WOMAN (*cont.*)

Besides, I can't disappear. I'm to be wed in a month. Some altar requires my presence.

MAN

Oh, congratulations. Where's your—

WOMAN

Guatemala.

MAN

What for?

WOMAN

Digging wells.

MAN

Oh, commendable.

WOMAN

It's what drew me to him.

5D · SEPARATION / DIFFERENT MEMORIES

WOMAN stands, takes a few steps.

MAN

And how do you manage the separation?

WOMAN walks back, sits on a closer bollard.

WOMAN

I don't think about that. [Pauses] To remember one thing while excluding everything else is a separation in itself.

MAN

Still it must be...

WOMAN

From time to time... And from time to time he sends me photos of water systems and children with strange-shaped hats.

MAN gets up and walks away. WOMAN follows.

MAN

But you're creating different memories...

WOMAN

All memories are an invention of repression.

5E · DAYDREAM / EDEN / MEMORY

They walk in silence.

WOMAN *(cont.)*

Human consciousness is oriented towards what hasn't arrived... You cannot live without daydreaming...

MAN

I think there is another way...

WOMAN

Those who can dream of the Garden of Eden are-

MAN *(cuts her off)*

Eden is a memory...

WOMAN

To not dream means to die. And it's never easy to die.

MAN

You cannot live without memory... It's never easy to die.

WOMAN

Feel that?

MAN

What?

WOMAN

A hint of hatred dwells in that belief... [Pause] The heart's memory eliminates the bad and magnifies the good. The mind's is quite the opposite. Either way, it's catering to first-world issues through a first-world lens...

5F · BOURGEOIS / LANGUAGE / "READ ME"

MAN

Tell me more.

WOMAN

The past. It's a Bourgeois self-interest... And it likes to draw all other interest into its own failure...

MAN

Bourgeois?

MAN looks down at his clothes.

WOMAN

My words poorly portray my thoughts...

MAN

Everything first sneaks in through language. Action comes later... Read me from your book.

WOMAN reads from book. (Insert passage)

MAN

I doubt you ever even notice when the skies change from day to night...

WOMAN

Hah... How can you tell?

MAN

The way you read...

5G · JACKET / GENEALOGY

WOMAN puts the book in her jacket pocket...

MAN

A beautiful jacket...

WOMAN

It was my mother's...

MAN

It reeks of genealogy... [Pause] The best color for a jacket... and for the leaves...

MAN walks away.

SCENE 6 — EXT. WOODS — CONTINUOUS

6A · BOY FINDS THE BED/MANGER

BOY walks through the opening and sees a BED/MANGER in the middle of the woods.

He slowly makes his way to it. He runs his hand over the sheets. He gets on.

He starts jumping. Slowly, then faster.

He starts to turn. Suddenly, he stops. He sees something. Tears well in his eyes.

A woman is standing in the distance.

SCENE 7 — EXT. LOVER'S LEAP/PARK — MOMENTS LATER

7A · TRANSLATION / WHAT IS LOST

MAN and WOMAN sit on a ledge. WOMAN reads from her book, pauses.

WOMAN

So you hate translations?

MAN

I don't hate them. In fact, I succumb to them.

WOMAN

But nothing can ever be transmitted in its entirety. Always a filtered remainder.

MAN

So, what is lost?

WOMAN

It's lost on me now. But, we can't help ourselves.

MAN

And why not?

7B · PRESERVATION / TWISTED WORDS / LANGUAGE AS FILTER

WOMAN contemplates.

MAN *(mockingly)*

Ah, so for preservation?

WOMAN

You twist my words.

MAN

You twist your own words! Language itself is a filtering of its own.

WOMAN

Language is just a mode of communication.

MAN

Yes, but not poetry. [Pause] Communication transmits what is already known. But what about the unknown? [Pause] What about the moment when something within the human being becomes too complete, too charged, too coherent to remain unexpressed... and therefore must take shape in the world?

7C · "A BECOMING?"

WOMAN *(mockingly)*

Oh, so a becoming?

MAN

You complicate the solution much beyond the problem itself... A poem makes you feel that something was felt. Expression is its arrival.

7D · FUTURAL / ELEGIAC / PRESENCE OF ABSENCE

WOMAN

Beauty is futural in action.

MAN

It is elegaic in substance.

Sit in silence.

MAN

If it is both, then perhaps it can never be perceived.

WOMAN

Beauty isn't a prisoner of perception. It's the master of it, and in that sense, beauty is simply presence.

MAN

And what about the presence of absence? I find that incredibly beautiful.

WOMAN

You must have your reasons.

MAN chuckles.

7E · MEASURED VS. FELT / ONE WITH NATURE

WOMAN

Some want time measured out. Some want it felt.

Sit in silence, deadlocked. This time, Nature remains silent too. Instead, the trees, the skies, beauty itself, listen in. MAN and WOMAN are one with Nature.

WOMAN

How old are the trees? The skies?

MAN

And the wind?

WOMAN

It's hard to say.

MAN

It's hard to know.

SCENE 8 — EXT. WOODS — CONTINUOUS

8A · FINAL IMAGE

WOMAN, now old, stands in the forest. She looks somberly into the distance.